

The Drained Water

Player-facing description

The Drained Water: Hush looks freshly painted and warmly tended, but the little public board is crowded with service fees, late-payment ribbons, and household ledger slips marked again and again in outgoing ink.

Public role

Clue / evidence

Handout text

Player-safe note: Hush looks freshly painted and warmly tended, but the little public board is crowded with service fees, late-payment ribbons, and household ledger slips marked again and again in outgoing ink.

GM truth

Use this element to reveal the cost of managed protection through concrete play.

GM handling

Use when players need a tangible handle on the scene's pressure.

Mechanics

- Title: Discovery / Earn-It Mechanics
- Player Safe: Players can inspect, handle, keep, trade, reveal, or earn The Drained Water when it is present in the fiction.
- Gm Only: Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete.
- No Roll Reveals: Surface read: Hush looks freshly painted and warmly tended, but the little public board is crowded with service fees, late-payment ribbons, and household ledger slips marked again and again in outgoing ink. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle.
- Rolls: entity-the-drained-water-engage-the-drained-water entity-the-drained-water Engage The Drained Water Engage The Drained Water Knowledge Finesse Instinct Presence Knowledge Finesse, Instinct, Presence 12 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of The Drained Water hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a...

- Fear Spends: Reveal who benefits from the current situation. Make the cost personal without closing off player agency.
- Condition Options: No official condition unless the item or clue physically creates Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable
- Search Loot: Player-safe note: Hush looks freshly painted and warmly tended, but the little public board is crowded with service fees, late-payment ribbons, and household ledger slips marked again and again in outgoing ink.

Profile

- Schema Version: clue-profile-v1
- Id: the-drained-water
- Clue Id: the-drained-water
- Clue Name: The Drained Water
- Name: The Drained Water
- Pronunciation: the DRAYND WAW-ter
- Clue Kind: environmental
- Auto Surface: True
- Atlas Lore Note: [Atlas lore - confirm or override]
- Player Safe: The Drained Water Hush looks freshly painted and warmly tended, but the little public board is crowded with service fees, late-payment ribbons, and household ledger slips marked again and again in outgoing ink. Hush looks freshly painted and warmly tended, but the little public board is crowded with service fees, late-payment ribbons, and household ledger slips marked again and again in outgoing ink. Hush looks freshly painted and warmly tended, but the little public board is crowded with service fees, late-payment ribbons, and household ledger slips marked again and again in outgoing ink.
- Block0: the-drained-water The Drained Water the DRAYND WAW-ter environmental
- Block1: Hush is being drained of coin, labor, and choices by protection fees and corporate services; low water may appear as a symptom, but the clue is economic exhaustion. HIDDEN Hush's Hidden Struggle hush-hidden-struggle Keeps Hush warm while making the cost of protection concrete. <pages/entities/the-drained-water.html> <pages/clues/hush-hidden-struggle.html>
- Block2: Hush looks freshly painted and warmly tended, but the little public board is crowded with service fees, late-payment ribbons, and household ledger slips marked again and again in outgoing ink. Hush is being drained of coin, labor, and choices by protection fees and corporate services; low water may appear as a symptom, but the clue is economic exhaustion.
- Block3: "the smiles are real, but the ledgers are thin." "every small comfort in Hush seems to have a fee attached." "Hush is not simply short on water; the village is being drained of wealth and breathing room." You have enough GM-only proof that Hush is being kept bright while money and labor flow outward through protection fees, service contracts, and corporate-managed necessities.
- Block4: The Cheerful Ledger The Ward Subscription the-cheerful-ledger the-ward-subscription
- Block5: S04-01 Hush The Clover Co-op Hush Farms Hush Safe Irrigation Path Knowledge 12 reading ledgers, Presence 12 talking with a shopkeeper or farmer, or Instinct 12 noticing the same outgoing-fee mark repeated across otherwise cheerful village

spaces. clues/Hush_Hidden_Struggle.md

- Block6: HIDDEN Use this clue to support Hush's Hidden Struggle: Hush is being drained of coin, labor, and choices by protection fees and corporate services; low water may appear as a symptom, but the clue is economic exhaustion. whisper True
- Block8: Bright, saturated storybook evidence illustration; clear hero shot of the actual clue object or scene detail; whimsical frontier-Renaissance materials; warm light; bright dystopian corporate satire when branded; no gore, no UI, no watermark, no repeated icon. Depict: a bright village notice board and household ledger slips covered in cheerful fee ribbons, outgoing coin marks, and tiny service stamps; a low irrigation channel is only a small background detail. clue wiki card and Player Display evidence visual Send the image and SHOW text only. Keep TELL, points_to, and blunt ladder rungs GM-only until earned. /Users/kyle/Documents/My Games/Peril To Profit/story-atlas/src/clue_images/the-drained-water/profile_base.png assets/clue-images/the-drained-water/profile_base.png Bright, saturated storybook evidence illustration; clear hero shot of the actual clue object or scene detail...
- Block9: Official Daggerheart action roll using Duality Dice, Hope, Fear, and Difficulty; P2P Roll Slider is the table-facing result ladder. Agility move, climb, dodge, reach a better angle, or read evidence while moving Strength lift, hold, force, carry, break, or test weight and pressure Finesse handle, hide, tinker, compare, pick apart, or notice precise detail Instinct perceive, smell, listen, track, read danger, or sense body language Presence charm, soothe, press, lead, deceive, perform, or read a social response Knowledge recall, analyze, investigate, reason from lore, or understand systems Instinct D14 Knowledge D14 Presence D14 If the clue is plainly visible, give the SHOW text freely first: Hush looks freshly painted and warmly tended, but the little public board is crowded with service fees, late-payment ribbons, and household ledger slips marked again and again in outgoing ink. Use...
- Mechanicids: duality-dice hope fear difficulty roll-slider clue-discovery
- Visual Assets: profile_base Clue evidence image /Users/kyle/Documents/My Games/Peril To Profit/story-atlas/src/clue_images/the-drained-water/profile_base.png assets/clue-images/the-drained-water/profile_base.png ready The Drained Water clue image. Hush looks freshly painted and warmly tended, but the little public board is crowded with service fees, late-payment ribbons, and household ledger slips marked again and again in outgoing ink.

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